Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. In my current data science work, I build forecasting, churn-scoring and experimentation solutions that connect model outputs to operational decisions, and I am keen to develop that experience further on a team taking AI ideas from prototype to production.

At Thistlebox, I built a scheduled LightGBM forecasting workflow that writes six-week-ahead recipe and region forecasts to BigQuery for operational use in Looker. WAPE improved from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. I also developed a weekly XGBoost churn-scoring workflow in BigQuery; a 10% holdout validation showed churn was 2.1 percentage points lower in the treated group. These projects have given me practical experience in feature engineering, evaluation and data workflows supporting business operations.

I have also built a Streamlit application for sequential A/B testing, used by around 25 colleagues in product and growth. I wrote its Dockerfile, while the data platform team manages deployment to Cloud Run. Since 2025, I have added pytest unit tests for forecasting feature code, reaching approximately 60% coverage. My MSc in Statistics, including a dissertation on Bayesian hierarchical models, supports this applied work with a grounding in modelling uncertainty and experimental design.

Quillstone's focus on helping merchants and its Customer Operations AI team's work on answering questions and routing tickets make this role particularly interesting to me. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my applied modelling and collaboration experience while developing further in the engineering practices needed to operate machine learning systems in production. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley